FUTURES MATTER EDUCATION

Futures Matter - Northwood, 122 Emily Street, Highgate, Birmingham, B12 0XJ

Relationships, Sex and Health Education (RSHE) Policy Statement

Reference: FME-CU-05

Last review: September 2026
Next review: September 2027

Reviewed by: Benjamin Neasom, Head Teacher
Carrie-Ann McGurk, Proprietor
Mark O'Donnell, Chair of School Governance Board

1.0 OUR COMMITMENT

Futures Matter - Northwood is a small independent special school for pupils aged 11 to 16 with social, emotional and mental health (SEMH) needs and autism. Every pupil has the right to learn how to stay safe, to build healthy and respectful relationships, and to look after their physical and mental health. We teach relationships, sex and health education (RSHE) as part of our personal, social, health, citizenship and economic education (PSHCEE) curriculum, in line with the Department for Education's statutory guidance that applies from 1 September 2026.

The full Relationships, Sex and Health Education Policy is available at futuresmattereducation.co.uk/policies and from the school office on request.

2.0 WHAT WE TEACH

- **Relationships education:** families, friendships, respectful relationships, online safety, consent, boundaries and how to get help when something is wrong.
- **Health education:** physical health, mental wellbeing, puberty, and how to look after ourselves.
- **Sex education:** sexual relationships and sexual health, including consent, the law, contraception and sexually transmitted infections, taught in a way that suits each pupil.
- **Science:** human reproduction and development, taught in science lessons and part of the national curriculum.

The full list of what pupils should know, and when we teach it, is in Appendices 1 and 2 of our RSHE Policy.

3.0 HOW WE TEACH

Our teaching is factual, sensitive and suited to each pupil's age, maturity and needs. We use small groups, clear and literal language, visual supports, advance warning of topics and a trauma-informed approach, and we link learning to each pupil's EHC plan outcomes. We teach the facts and the law, including the Equality Act 2010 and the protected characteristics, and we respect pupils' faiths and beliefs. We do not promote any particular view on contested issues, and we make sure any external resources are suitable and checked beforehand.

4.0 WORKING WITH PARENTS AND CARERS

- We consult parents and carers whenever we develop or review the policy, using the consultation materials in our RSHE Consultation and Withdrawal Pack, and we publish the policy on our website.
- We share what we teach and a sample of our resources, and parents and carers can ask to see any RSHE material at any time.
- We listen carefully to views and concerns. Parents and carers cannot veto what we teach, but we explain our approach and we take their views into account.
- To talk to us about RSHE, contact the Head Teacher, Benjamin Neasom, on 0121 835 1360 or at office@futuresmattereducation.co.uk.

5.0 THE RIGHT TO WITHDRAW

Parents and carers can ask for their child to be withdrawn from some or all of sex education, until three terms before the pupil turns 16. After that point, the pupil can choose to receive sex education, and we will arrange this. Parents and carers cannot withdraw their child from relationships education, health education or anything taught in science.

To make a request, use the withdrawal request form in our RSHE Consultation and Withdrawal Pack, available from the school office on request, or write to the Head Teacher. We will offer a meeting to talk it through. In exceptional circumstances, for example because of a safeguarding concern or a pupil's particular vulnerability, the Head Teacher can refuse a request. If a request is approved, the pupil will have meaningful alternative learning during those lessons.

6.0 SAFEGUARDING AND CONFIDENTIALITY

Pupils may share worries during RSHE. Staff cannot promise confidentiality when a pupil's safety may be at risk, and will follow our Safeguarding and Child Protection Policy. Our Designated Safeguarding Lead is Benjamin Neasom, Head Teacher.

7.0 LINKS WITH OTHER POLICIES

- Safeguarding and Child Protection Policy
- Online Safety and Acceptable Use Policy
- Anti-Bullying Policy
- Behaviour Policy
- Equality, Diversity and Inclusion Policy
- Curriculum Policy and SEND Policy
- Data Protection Policy and Privacy Notices
- Complaints Policy